

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8b-0pcc-ezdt
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-6804

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

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General Comment

From a concerned citizen and small business owner.

Re: National Science Foundation's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

I am an everyday American who runs a small visual design business. I have worked hard for years to develop the skills and knowledge to build my business, and have been lucky enough to make a decent living – until recently.

The AI systems made by Big Tech companies like OpenAI (Microsoft) and Google threaten to destroy thousands of American small businesses like mine with their recent demand to create special carve outs in copyright law.

AI systems can only be produced by first training on work made by people. My unique work, and the work of hundreds of thousands of other everyday American creators was taken and fed into these AI systems without our consent or any compensation. They ingest our work, reassemble it, and then sell it back to our clients – directly competing with us and cutting us out of the marketplace.

Now these Big Tech companies are asking this administration to create exceptions and loopholes to make this practice of stealing American creators' copyrighted work legal precedent. They are suggesting that if a machine ingests and reproduces copyrighted work, it is somehow suddenly "fair use".

They seem to believe that anything and everything on the internet – regardless of who owns it – should be theirs for the taking. They claim that if this administration does not allow them to rewrite the law in this way, it will stifle American innovation.

Instead, it will have the opposite effect. The purpose of American copyright law is to protect the incentive to create and innovate.

If we the American people do not own our creations, and everything we put online will be stolen by Big Tech giants, what will be the incentive to create? If everyday Americans create a new innovative piece of computer code, a new visual design, or a new piece of music only to have it immediately stolen by Google and Microsoft, why bother creating it in the first place? How will we possibly make a living doing these things?

Want to protect American innovation? Protect American creators. Do not create new copyright exemptions that allow Big Tech companies to exploit and steal from creators and everyday Americans without permission, compensation, or transparency.

AI is not the future of the American economy, it is a bubble that will eventually burst leaving endless debts in its wake, but not before destroying the futures of countless American creatives who could be giving back to the economy instead of the pockets of foreign shareholders once American intellectual properties no longer have any value.

The loss of copyright protections would affect small and big businesses alike, and America would no longer be the world's entertainment capitol.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on these important issues.